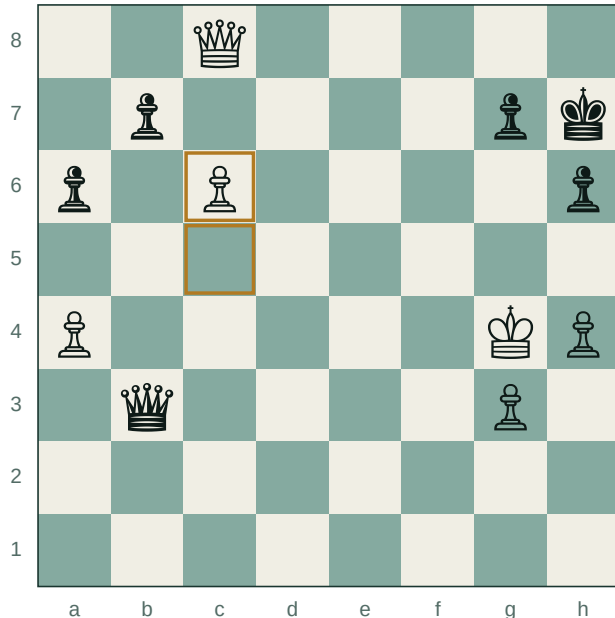


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 52

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 52.c6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52...Qxa4+ 53. Kh3 Qxc6

52...Qxa4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on a4. Recorded reply: **53.Kh3**.

53...Qxc6 The queen captures the pawn on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g4. Geometrically undefended: queen on c8. Check for tactical protection.